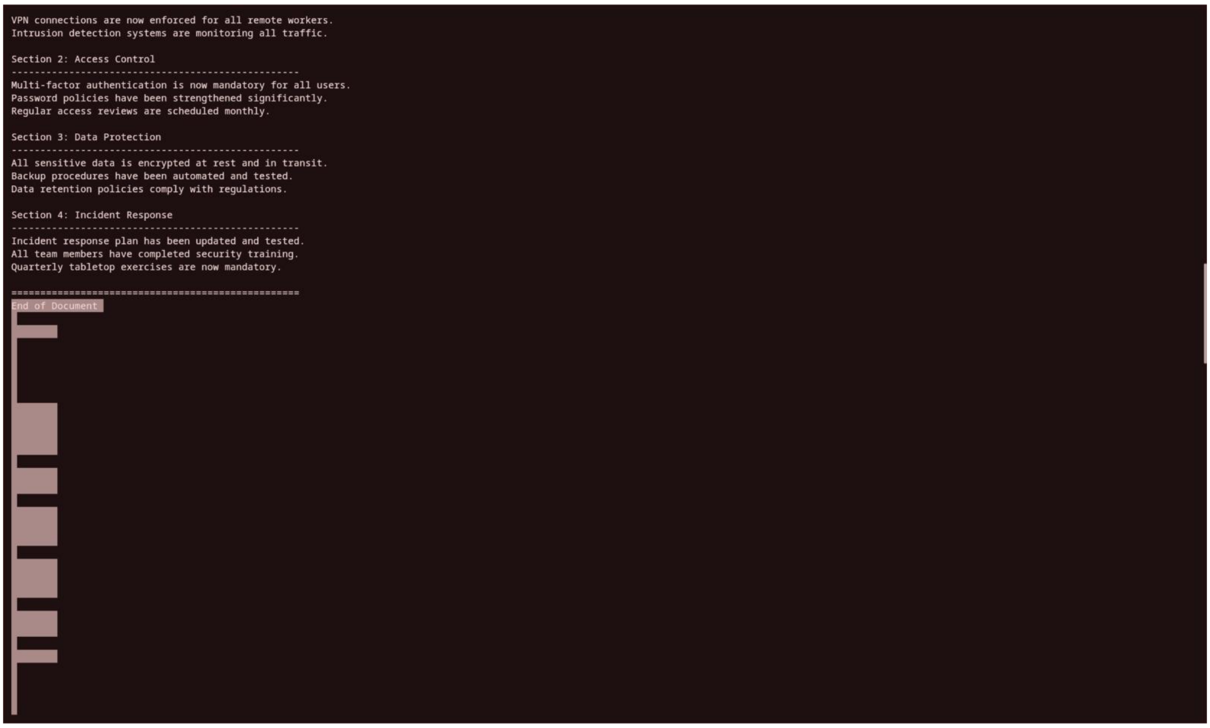
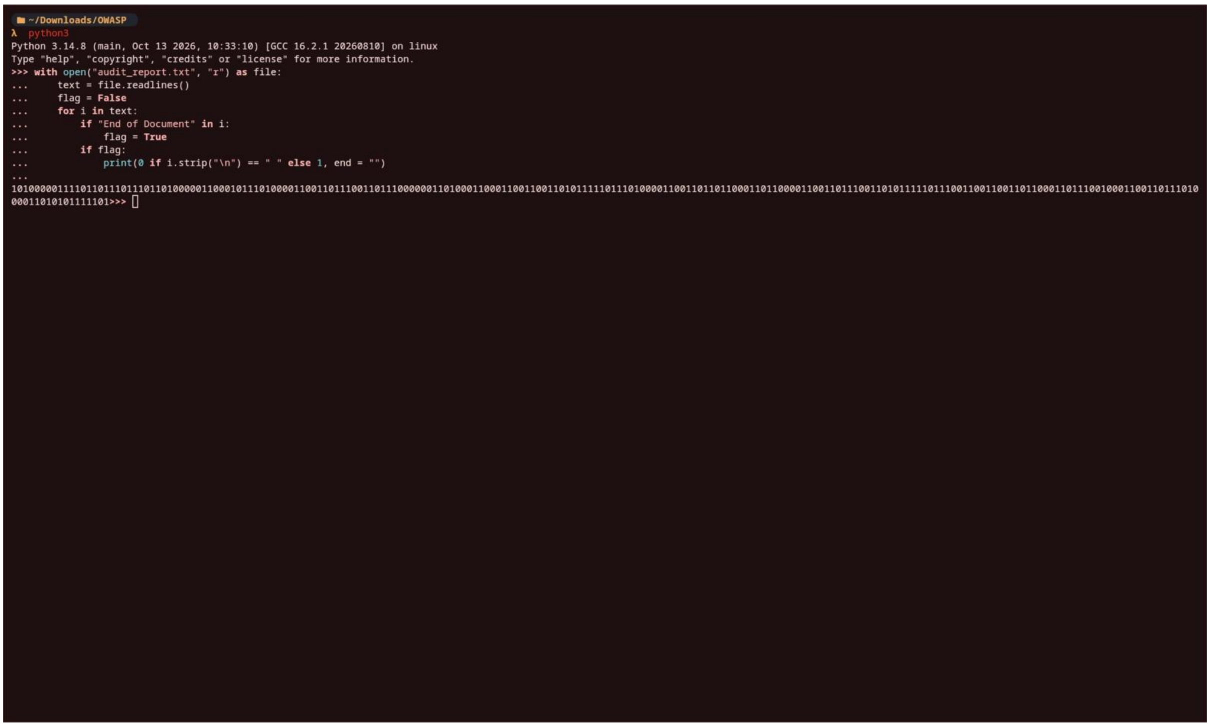
# Ghost In The Text – Forensics

Step 1 - The end of the document contains lines with tabs and empty lines (empty lines counted as 0 and tabs counted as 1)



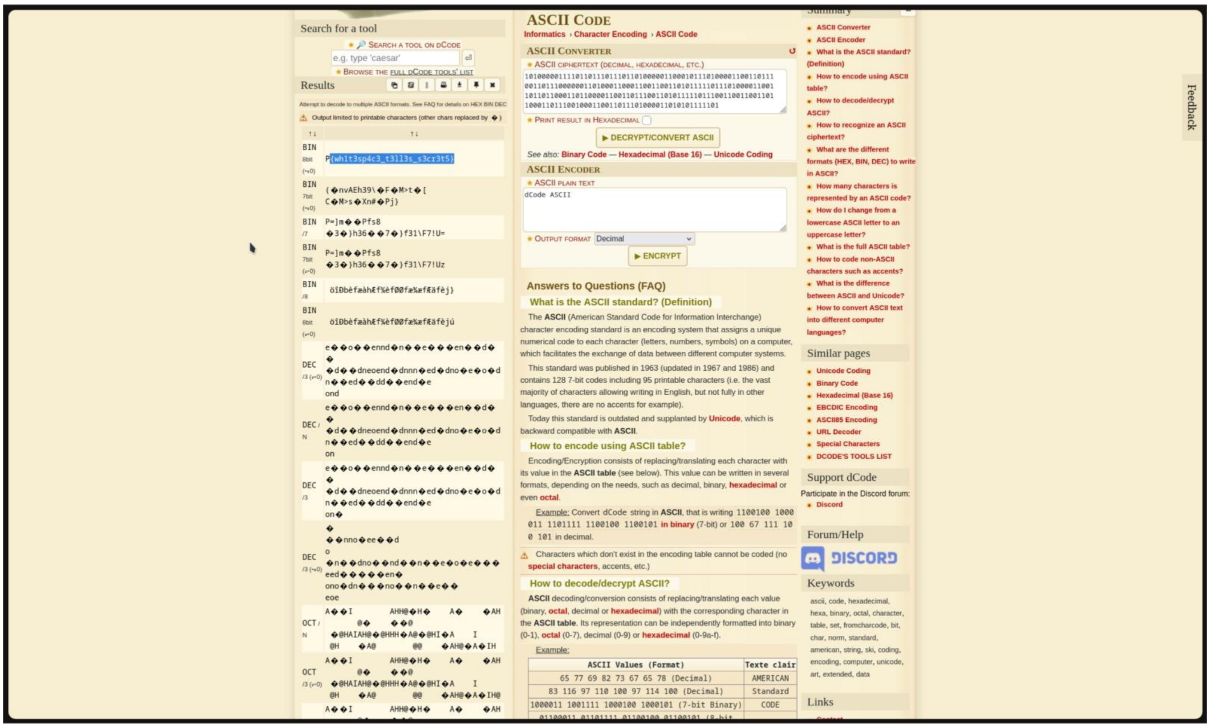
```
VPN connections are now enforced for all remote workers.
Intrusion detection systems are monitoring all traffic.

Section 2: Access Control
--------------------------------------------------
Multi-factor authentication is now mandatory for all users.
Password policies have been strengthened significantly.
Regular access reviews are scheduled monthly.

Section 3: Data Protection
--------------------------------------------------
All sensitive data is encrypted at rest and in transit.
Backup procedures have been automated and tested.
Data retention policies comply with regulations.

Section 4: Incident Response
--------------------------------------------------
Incident response plan has been updated and tested.
All team members have completed security training.
Quarterly tabletop exercises are now mandatory.

==================================================
End of Document
```

Step 2 - A python script is used to read the document and extract tab and empty lines



```
~/Downloads/OWASP
λ  python3
Python 3.14.8 (main, Oct 13 2026, 10:33:10) [GCC 16.2.1 20260810] on linux
Type "help", "copyright", "credits" or "license" for more information.
>>> with open("audit_report.txt", "r") as file:
...     text = file.readlines()
...     flag = False
...     for i in text:
...         if "End of Document" in i:
...             flag = True
...         if flag:
...             print(0 if i.strip("\n") == " " else 1, end = "")
...
10100000111101101110111011010000011000101110100001100110111001101110000001101000110001100110011010111110111010000110011001101101100011011000011001101110011010111110111001100110011011000110111001000110011011101 0
00011010101111101>>> 
```

Step 3 - The binary output is decoded into ascii value



Search for a tool
SEARCH A TOOL ON DCODE
e.g. type 'caesar'
BROWSE THE FULL DCODE TOOLS' LIST
Results
ASCII CODE
Informatics › Character Encoding › ASCII Code
ASCII CONVERTER
ASCII CIPHERTEXT (DECIMAL, HEXADECIMAL, ETC.)
PRINT RESULT IN HEXADECIMAL ☐
▶ DECRYPT/CONVERT ASCII
See also: Binary Code — Hexadecimal (Base 16) — Unicode Coding
ASCII ENCODER
ASCII PLAIN TEXT
OUTPUT FORMAT Decimal
▶ ENCRYPT
Summary
ASCII Converter
ASCII Encoder
What is the ASCII standard? (Definition)
How to encode using ASCII table?
How to decode/decrypt ASCII?
How to recognize an ASCII ciphertext?
What are the different formats (HEX, BIN, DEC) to write in ASCII?
How many characters is represented by an ASCII code?
How do I change from a lowercase ASCII letter to an uppercase letter?
What is the full ASCII table?
How to code non-ASCII characters such as accents?
What are the difference between ASCII and Unicode?
How to convert ASCII text into different computer languages?
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Keywords
ascii, code, hexadecimal, hexa, binary, octal, character, table, set, fromcharcode, bit, char, norm, standard, american, string, ski, coding, encoding, computer, unicode, art, extended, data
Links
Feedback

Attempt to decode to multiple ASCII formats. See FAQ for details on HEX BIN DEC

⚠ Output limited to printable characters (other chars replaced by �)

```
BIN 8bit (=0)      P{wh1t3sp4c3_t3ll3s_s3cr3t5}
BIN 7bit (=0)      (�nvAEh39\�F�M>t�[
                   C�M>s�Xn#�Pj)
BIN /7             P=]m��Pfs8
                   �3�}h36��7�}f31\F7!U=
BIN 7bit (=0)      P=]m��Pfs8
                   �3�}h36��7�}f31\F7!Uz
BIN /8             öîÐbèfæàhÆf%èfØØfæ%æfÆäfèj}
BIN 8bit (=0)      öîÐbèfæàhÆf%èfØØfæ%æfÆäfèjú
DEC /3 (=0)        e��o��ennd�n��e���en��d�
                   �
                   �d��dneoend�dnnn�ed�dno�e�o�d
                   n��ed��dd��end�e
                   ond
DEC / N            e��o��ennd�n��e���en��d�
                   �
                   �d��dneoend�dnnn�ed�dno�e�o�d
                   n��ed��dd��end�e
                   on
DEC /3             e��o��ennd�n��e���en��d�
                   �
                   �d��dneoend�dnnn�ed�dno�e�o�d
                   n��ed��dd��end�e
                   on�
DEC /3 (=0)        �
                   ��nno�ee��d
                   o
                   �n��dno��nd��n��e�o�e���
                   eed�����en�
                   ono�dn���no��n��e��
                   eoe
OCT / N            A��I        AHH@�H�     A�      �AH
                        @�       ��@
                    �@HAIAH@�@HHH�A@�@HI�A     I
                    @H     �A@         @@     �AH@�A�IH
OCT /3 (=0)        A��I        AHH@�H�     A�      �AH
                        @�       ��@
                    �@HAIAH@�@HHH�A@�@HI�A     I
                    @H     �A@         @@     �AH@�A�IH@
                   A��I        AHH@�H�     A�      �AH
```

ASCII ciphertext:

```
10100000111101101110111011010000011000101110100001100110111
00110111000000110100011000110011001101011111011101000011001
10110110001101100001100110111001101011111011100110011001101
1000110111001000110011011101000011010101111101
```

ASCII plain text:

```
dCode ASCII
```

**Answers to Questions (FAQ)**

**What is the ASCII standard? (Definition)**

The **ASCII** (American Standard Code for Information Interchange) character encoding standard is an encoding system that assigns a unique numerical code to each character (letters, numbers, symbols) on a computer, which facilitates the exchange of data between different computer systems.

This standard was published in 1963 (updated in 1967 and 1986) and contains 128 7-bit codes including 95 printable characters (i.e. the vast majority of characters allowing writing in English, but not fully in other languages, there are no accents for example).

Today this standard is outdated and supplanted by Unicode, which is backward compatible with **ASCII**.

**How to encode using ASCII table?**

Encoding/Encryption consists of replacing/translating each character with its value in the **ASCII table** (see below). This value can be written in several formats, depending on the needs, such as decimal, binary, hexadecimal or even octal.

Example: Convert dCode string in **ASCII**, that is writing `1100100 1000011 1101111 1100100 1100101` in binary (7-bit) or `100 67 111 100 101` in decimal.

⚠ Characters which don't exist in the encoding table cannot be coded (no special characters, accents, etc.)

**How to decode/decrypt ASCII?**

**ASCII** decoding/conversion consists of replacing/translating each value (binary, octal, decimal or hexadecimal) with the corresponding character in the **ASCII table**. Its representation can be independently formatted into binary (0-1), octal (0-7), decimal (0-9) or hexadecimal (0-9a-f).

Example:

| ASCII Values (Format) | Texte clair |
|---|---|
| 65 77 69 82 73 67 65 78 (Decimal) | AMERICAN |
| 83 116 97 110 100 97 114 100 (Decimal) | Standard |
| 1000011 1001111 1000100 1000101 (7-bit Binary) | CODE |

Flag - OWASP{wh1t3sp4c3_t3ll3s_s3cr3t5}